

Sales Playbook

Internal commercial guidance

Access level: worker

Ideal customer profile

The strongest opportunities are organizations with 100-2,000 employees, several disconnected business systems and a visible operational bottleneck that has measurable cost or customer impact. Buyers are typically operations leaders, finance leaders, commercial directors or digital-transformation managers.

Qualification framework

- Problem: Is there a clear operational pain point?
- Impact: Can the customer estimate time, cost, risk or revenue impact?
- Owner: Is there a person accountable for solving it?
- Urgency: Why should the customer act now?
- Access: Can Northstar reach business and technical stakeholders?
- Budget: Is there a realistic path to funded implementation?

Discovery call structure

1. Confirm the business context and desired outcome.
2. Map the current process at a high level.
3. Identify delays, manual steps, rework and data gaps.
4. Understand systems involved and likely integration constraints.
5. Define what a successful pilot would prove.
6. Agree the next step, owner and date before ending the call.

Opportunity stages

Stage	Exit criterion
Qualified	Problem, owner and next step confirmed
Discovery	Use case and stakeholders understood
Solution fit	Proposed approach reviewed with customer
Proposal	Commercial proposal delivered
Negotiation	Open commercial or legal points actively discussed
Closed won	Signed order or contract received
Closed lost	Reason recorded in CRM

Commercial principles

Sales should avoid discounting before value and scope are understood. Standard pricing may be adapted for contract length, user count, strategic reference value and implementation effort, but exceptions must follow approval rules.

Handover quality

A strong handover includes the customer objective, key stakeholders, promised scope, exclusions, dependencies, success metrics, expected timeline and any non-standard commitments. The account owner remains involved until the delivery lead confirms a stable project start.

CRM discipline

Material customer interactions should be logged within one working day. Opportunity value, stage, next step and expected close date should reflect the current reality rather than the desired outcome.